



Copy and paste lines without moving the cursor in Vim

Vim is an awesome editor, and one of the great things about it is that you can manage complex things with simple commands. Let us look at one more great feature of Vim, which enables you to copy and paste certain lines without moving the cursor.

Let's suppose you have a file with 10 lines and currently, the cursor is at Line 5. You now want to copy Lines 1 to 4 after Line 8. For this, you can use Vim's 'co' command, which has the following syntax. Please note that the command must be used with Vim's 'ex' mode.

Syntax:

```
: [address range] co destination
```

In our example, the address range is '1, 4', the destination is '8' and 'co' is the command name, which implies the 'copy' operation.

Usage:

It's now time for action. Let us create a test file with 10 lines.

```
[bash]$ for i in {1..10}; do echo "line #$i"; done > junk.txt
```

Next, open the above file in the Vim editor and execute the following command in 'ex' mode and verify the output.

```
" :1, 4 co 8"
```

It's amazing, right?

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Shortcut keys for the terminal

Here is a small tip that will introduce you to a few of the shortcut keys that can also work as replacements to the arrow and backspace keys.

Ctrl + Alt + t: To open the terminal

Ctrl + Shift + n: To open a new terminal window

Ctrl + Shift + t: To open a new tab in the terminal window

Ctrl + a: Moves the cursor to the beginning of a line (at one shot)

Ctrl + e: Moves the cursor to the end of the line (at one shot)

Ctrl + f: Moves the cursor to the right side of the line (one character at a time)

Ctrl + b: Moves the cursor to the left side of the line (one character at a time)

Ctrl + u: Deletes the left side of the cursor (at one shot)

Ctrl + k: Deletes the right side of the cursor (at one shot)

Ctrl + h: Deletes the left side of the cursor (one character at a time; equivalent to using the Backspace key)

Ctrl + d: Deletes the right side of the cursor (one character at a time)

Ctrl + w: Deletes the word before the cursor (separated by a space)

Ctrl + c: Discards all the characters and gives a new command prompt (or say, kills the process)

Ctrl + r: Finds the last command matching the entered characters

Ctrl + y: Pastes the string deleted by *Ctrl+k*, *Ctrl+u* and *Ctrl+w*

Ctrl + t: Swaps the character under the cursor with the character just before it

Ctrl + j, *Ctrl + m*, *Ctrl + o*: Equivalent to enter key

Ctrl + p: Equivalent to the up-arrow key

Ctrl + n: Equivalent to the down-arrow key

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